Teacher Guide & Answers

Passage Reading Level: Lexile 1110

Featured Text Structure: Argumentative – the writer presents evidence for both sides of an argument

Passage Summary: "News Debate: Firefight" presents both sides of a debate about whether or not teens should play violent video games.

1. What California law did the U.S. Supreme Court recently overturn?

- **A** a law that required minors to stop playing violent video games
- **B** a law that made it a criminal offense to sell violent video games
- **C** a law that banned violent video games from all stores in California
- **D** **a law that barred stores from selling violent video games to minors**

2. The passage shows two sides of this debate: Should teens play violent video games? According to the passage, what is one argument that teens should be able to play violent video games?

- **A** Prolonged exposure to violent images can change a teen's personality.
- **B** Violent video games sometimes increase aggressive behavior in teens.
- **C** **Teens are smart enough to know the difference between real life and fantasy.**
- **D** When teens play violent video games, they often confuse fantasy and reality.

3. What can you most likely conclude about how Melissa Henson felt about the Supreme Court ruling described in the passage?

- **A** **She was most likely upset about the ruling.**
- **B** She was most likely thrilled about the ruling.
- **C** She was most likely indifferent to the ruling.
- **D** She was most likely happy about the ruling.

4. Read this sentence from the passage: "'[We] found consistent evidence that violent games increase desensitization [and] aggressive thoughts, feelings, physiology, and behaviors and decrease helpful behaviors,' they say."

In this sentence, the word **desensitization** means

- **A** foolish thinking
- **B** **loss of sensitivity**
- **C** confusion
- **D** violent action

5. The author starts the passage with this one-word sentence: "Warning!" Why did the author most likely start the passage this way?

- **A** to exclaim his or her hatred of video games
- **B** **to grab the reader's attention from the start**
- **C** to warn young kids not to read the passage
- **D** to show how overly dramatic people can be

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6. Who are Douglas A. Gentile and Craig A. Anderson? Where do they work?

Suggested answer: They are psychologists and professors at Iowa State University. [paragraph 1 after subhead "Game Stop…"]

7. Why did Justice Antonin Scalia point out that fairy tales are violent? Which sentences from the article support your answer?

Suggested answer: He pointed out that fairy tales are violent to show that violent video games are no more violent than the fairy tales kids read when they are younger. These sentences from the article support my answer: "In the original version of 'Hansel and Gretel,' for example, the children kill the witch by baking her in an oven. 'Certainly the books we give children to read—or read to them when they are younger—contain no shortage of gore,' Scalia wrote in the Court's decision. [paragraph 2 after subhead "Play On…"]

8. The question below is an incomplete sentence. Choose the word that best completes the sentence.

Some people argue that playing violent video games causes neither harmful thoughts _____ violent behaviors.

A and
B **nor**
C for
D as

9. Answer the following questions based on the sentence below.

Raven Laddish avoids video games such as Grand Theft Auto because those types of games don't appeal to her and she doesn't like the message the games send to teens.

Who? **Raven Laddish**

(does) What? avoids video games such as Grand Theft Auto

Why? **because those types of games don't appeal to her and she doesn't like the message the games send to teens**

10. **Vocabulary Word**: reinforces: encourages or supports.

Use the vocabulary word in a sentence: answers may vary.

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